Parkdale Hub – Phase 3
Local Advisory Committee Meeting

MEETING SUMMARY

Tuesday, December 6, 2022
6:00 p.m. – 7:30 p.m., Virtual Meeting

Overview

On Tuesday, December 6, 2022, CreateTO hosted a Local Advisory Committee (LAC) meeting for Phase 3 of the Parkdale Hub project. The purpose of the meeting was to share updates, and answer questions about Phase 3 of the Parkdale Hub Project *(see attachment A for the meeting agenda).* 9 LAC members, representing 9 organizations attended the meeting *(see attachment B for a list of organizations).* Councillor Gord Perks and his office, staff from the City's Housing Secretariat, City Planning, Parks, Forestry Recreation, Social Development Finance and Administration, Toronto Public Library and members of the project consultant team also attended and participated in the meeting.

Following the land acknowledgement and welcoming remarks from Councillor Gord Perks, Matthew Wheatley, independent facilitator from Third Party Public, reviewed the agenda and facilitated a round of introductions. CreateTO, City Planning and DTAH (consultants leading the design of the demonstration plan) provided an update on the Parkdale Hub project, a review of the feedback shared in Phase 2 and a recap of the demonstration plan. Participants then asked questions and shared comments through a facilitated discussion.

Third Party Public facilitated the meeting and prepared this meeting summary and shared it with participants for review before it was finalized. This summary is intended to reflect key discussion points from the meeting and is not intended to be a verbatim transcript

Summary of questions and feedback

Following the presentation, Local Advisory Committee members asked questions and shared comments through a facilitated discussion. LAC members were also encouraged to share any additional feedback and/or questions with the team after the meeting. This summary includes feedback and questions shared by LAC members during and following the meeting up until December 13, 2022.

Key themes emerged during the discussion and are summarized. These reoccurring themes should be read along with the more detailed summary of questions and comments that follow:

- **Continued excitement for the Parkdale Hub project and support for the work being done to advance the process.**
- **Interest in including as much affordable space on the site as possible**, both affordable housing that includes deeply affordable units and family-sized units and affordable space for community programs and resources.
- **Interest and support for new community space.** LAC members shared excitement about the opportunities for new community space to serve the local community. They discussed the importance of sharing information and seeking feedback about how the new community space will be designed, allocated, and managed/owned to ensure it serves the local community well.
- **Strong support for continued engagement with local organizations and members of the community as the process moves forward.** Participants discussed the importance of proactively sharing information and having and documenting conversations with the

community so that they can continue to help inform the design of the Hub, including the detailed design.

Over the course of the meeting, LAC members asked questions and shared comments about a variety of topics. The questions asked are organized below in **bold text**, followed by responses and comments from the project team in *italics*, where provided.

Questions and comments about the overall design and built form

Participants said they were generally impressed with the design, massing, and consideration for improvements to the public realm.

From an environmental perspective, has the team considered what type of materials are being used for the exterior of the development? *This level of detail will be addressed during the Site Plan application stage of the project. One of the requirements is that this project is at minimum meeting the Toronto Green Standard Tier 2 Version 4.*

Consider adjusting the building envelope to make space for more family sized units. Parkdale has limited 3 and 4 bedroom units and needs a significant increase in family sized units. Look for opportunities to extend / bump out the building to add more floor space to help accommodate more 3 and 4 bedroom units. *The floorplates presented today are still demonstration plans and not final. The number of units in the building will be part of the non-profit developer's submission to the City as part of the Request for Proposal process. The breakdown of units by type will reflect meeting the City's requirement for a mix of unit types and reflect the needs of the tenants they'd like to serve.*

The extension of Milky Way Lane into a two way lane is an exciting idea. Consider the possibility to convene property owners that connect to Milky Way Lane, like the Parkdale Neighbourhood Land Trust, to further extend Milky Way Lane. The Parkdale Neighbourhood Land Trust would be interested in engaging on any future opportunities.

Questions and comments about affordable housing

Clarify and define the different components of affordable housing on this site. For example, what is considered affordable, how many units will be affordable, and will the site provide rents for a mix of incomes? It is also important to consider that 80% of average market rent is not very affordable for many people in the Parkdale neighbourhood. *On average*, a*ffordable rental units created through Housing Now will rent for 80 per cent of Toronto's average market rent; with some rents being deeply affordable, renting as low as 40 per cent of the average market rent. The current target is for 50% of all units be affordable.*

A representative of the LAC shared feedback following the meeting that there is strong interest in having all housing units be affordable. They noted that doing so would align with recommendations laid out in the Parkdale Community Benefits Framework (developed by Parkdale People's Economy) that calls for 100% social housing on all publicly-owned lands.

Is the project team looking for one housing provider or multiple? *The City's Housing Secretariat will decide whether it is one or more partners that will be sought out.*

Questions and comments about community space

Request that the project team clearly explain who will have ownership and management of the ground floor community and/or commercial space. *The community space on the ground floor in the west and east block buildings will be owned and managed by the City. It is important to note that this space will be community space, not commercial space.*

Consider an opportunity for some of the ground floor community space to be owned and managed by the community. The Parkdale community organizations are very interconnected, and work well together. Community ownership and management of some of the community space would benefit the local community.

Creating opportunities for Community Benefits in Parkdale. A LAC member shared feedback following the meeting, identifying opportunities for community benefits that members of the Parkdale Community have shown interest in. These include urban agriculture/beekeeping and local training and employment opportunities during the construction and operation of the site.

Additional comments and suggestions about the future community space, included:

- Ensure organizations are included in the planning of community space within the Parkdale Hub;
- Ensure spaces are accessible, convenient and affordable for the organizations themselves, as well as being low-barrier access to the community for spaces such as meeting rooms and activity spaces. A lot of community organizations run affordable programs for the underserved population in Parkdale that have high needs. It is important that any new space that organizations move into includes affordable rent to allow programs to continue;
- Consider creating smaller community spaces, as many organizations are small and may not be able to afford larger physical space;
- Consider that some organizations may be interested in sharing space to run programs in joint partnership;
- Consider having new space be “turnkey” as opposed to “raw space” to help organizations move in and get up and running quickly; and
- Share as much information as soon as possible about how and when space will be allocated as organizations need to be given sufficient time to plan ahead when considering to be part of the community space.

There will be continued engagement and conversation with community organizations as the Hub develops. The team wants to maximize as much community space as they can. The City’s Social Development Finance and Administration (SDFA) division deals with community space being available at low market rental rates, as part of their Community Space Tenant Policy. Conversations will continue with the community and SDFA as the process continues to move forward.

Questions and comments about Artscape

Will the Artscape units be rent controlled? *The City's Rental Housing Demolition and Conversion by-law and Official Plan Housing Policies protect and preserve rental housing proposed for demolition by securing replacement rental units through redevelopment. Tenants have the right to return to replacement rental units at similar rents to what they currently pay. All rental replacement units are subject to the Provincial Rent Increase Guidelines for 10 years or until the tenancy ends. More information in relation to the replacement rental units will come forward through separate tenant meetings, which will be led by City Planning's Housing Policy staff.*

Who will own/manage the current Artscape units when the Hub is complete? *The Artscape units are on a lease through the City's Corporate Real Estate Management Division. It is our understanding that the relationship will continue through that sublease.*

Consider including 10-feet ceilings for the live-work units in Artscape. High ceilings are essential to the livelihood of artists in live-work units. *The demonstration plan has been developed to provide flexibility for features such as high ceilings. Features of the detailed design will be determined at the Site-Plan stage, which will take place in the next phase of the process.*

Comments about process

Ensure priorities and suggestions shared throughout the process by members of the LAC and the local community are well documented and communicated.

Provide as much information as soon as possible about the process for selecting a development partner or partners. There are some affordable community housing providers in and around Parkdale that would be interested to bid but would need the time to think through how to bid.

Next steps

The project team thanked members of the LAC for their ongoing participation in the process, noting that this project has and will continue to work because of community involvement and leadership. The facilitation team reminded LAC members to share any additional feedback by December 13 and committed to sharing a draft meeting summary following this date.

Attachment A. LAC participants

Below is a list of organizations that attended the LAC meeting.

- Parkdale Residents Association
- Parkdale Land Trust
- Neighbourhood Land Trust
- Gallery 1313
- Green 13
- Culture Link Settlement Services
- Parkdale People’s Economy
- More than Child’s Play
- Kababayan Multucultural Centre

Attachment B. Meeting Agenda

Parkdale Hub – Phase 3
Local Advisory Committee Meeting
Tuesday, December 6, 2022
6:00 – 7:30 pm
Meeting held online via Webex

Meeting purpose: to introduce, share updates, and answer questions about phase 3 of the Parkdale Hub Project

Agenda

6:00 Welcome, land acknowledgement, introductions, agenda review

6:10 Presentation

6:40 Questions & Answers

7:25 Wrap up and next steps

7:30 Adjourn